

TIFANI HUSNA SIREGAR

tifani.siregar@kfupm.edu.sa | tifanihusna@asagi.waseda.jp | [tifanihusna.github.io](https://github.com/tifanihusna) | [Google Scholar](#)

Research Interests: Applied Economics · Labor Markets · Spatial Econometrics · Causal Inference · Policy Evaluation · Financial Inclusion · Digital Finance

PROFILE

I am an applied economist specializing in labor markets, regional disparities, financial inclusion, and the economics of infrastructure and digital finance. My research combines spatial panel methods, causal inference tools, and satellite data to study how policies, infrastructure, and fintech-driven transformation shape economic outcomes. With a strong track record of publishing in top-tier SSCI/Scopus Q1 journals (e.g., *Transportation Research Part A*, *Economic Modelling*, and *Bulletin of Indonesian Economic Studies*) and professional policy experience with the Asian Development Bank Institute (ADBI), I bridge advanced data analytics with actionable public policy insights to address regional economic transformations. My current research examines stock market liberalization on the Tadawul exchange, digital payment adoption under Vision 2030, and the effects of the Haramain High Speed Railway on the local economy of KSA. I have ongoing collaborations with researchers at KFUPM, Waseda University, Nagoya University, ADB/ADBI, and Bank Indonesia.

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

Postdoctoral Fellow

2024 – Present

Interdisciplinary Research Center for Finance and Digital Economy (IRC-FDE), KFUPM, Saudi Arabia

- Research: Empirical research on fintech, financial inclusion, and digital economy in Saudi Arabia, with a focus on policy-relevant applications aligned with Vision 2030.
- Teaching: Designed and delivered undergraduate Introductory Econometrics (ECON-405), combining theory and hands-on Stata lab sessions. Student evaluation: **9.34/10 (2025)**.
- Funded project: KFUPM Fintech Center Research Grant 2026 — Foreign Ownership Liberalization and Stock Market Quality on the Tadawul.

Assistant Professor (助教)

2022 – 2023

School of Political Science and Economics, Waseda University, Japan

- Research: Independent research agenda in labor and regional economics.
- Teaching: Teaching fellow for undergraduate statistics (R lab sessions).

Research Associate

2021 – 2022

Asian Development Bank Institute (ADBI), Tokyo, Japan

- Empirical research on infrastructure, regional development, and fiscal policy; contributed to ADBI working papers, book chapters, and G20/T20 policy briefs.
- Co-organized international conferences, capacity-building workshops, and policy seminars attended by government officials across Asia-Pacific.

Academic Writing Tutor

2020 – 2021

Waseda University, Japan

INDUSTRY EMPLOYMENT

Corporate Credit Analyst / Research Analyst

2014 – 2017

MUFG Bank, Jakarta Branch

- Produced macroeconomic and sectoral research reports (automotive, electronics, food & beverage) to inform credit risk assessments and portfolio strategy.
- Performed corporate credit risk analysis: financial statement evaluation, management interviews, and site visits supporting loan approval and monitoring decisions.

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics — Graduate School of Economics, Waseda University, Japan

2017 – 2022

Dissertation: *The Impacts of Minimum Wages on the Indonesian Labor Market Outcomes*

MA in Economics — Graduate School of Economics, Waseda University, Japan

2012 – 2014

Bachelor's in Economics — Faculty of Economics and Management, IPB University, Indonesia

2006 – 2010

Selected Short Courses:

- Quantitative Methods for Causal Inference and Policy Evaluation — Essex Summer School, University of Essex (2022)
- Spatial Econometrics — Essex Summer School, University of Essex (2021)
- Student Centered Teaching with the Case Method — Harvard Business Impact, KFUPM Business School (2025)

TEACHING

Courses taught:

- Introductory Econometrics (ECON-405), KFUPM — undergraduate lecture + Stata lab; **student rating 9.34/10** (2025)
- Statistics for Economics and Political Science, Waseda University — undergraduate R lab sessions (2022)

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles

1. "Okun's Law and Spatial Regimes in Indonesia: A Machine Learning Approach" with Harry Aginta and Carlos Mendez. *Economic Modelling* (SSCI, Scopus Q1 — Economics & Econometrics) <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.econmod.2026.107687>
2. "Women's Reforms, Digital Payments, and Financial Inclusion in Saudi Arabia: Evidence from Global Findex 2014–2024" with Adnan Bakather and Emilios Galariotis. *FinTech*, 2026 (ESCI, Scopus Q1 — Economics, Econometrics and Finance) <https://doi.org/10.3390/fintech5020030>
3. "Minimum Wage Differentials and Commuting Across Districts: Evidence from the Greater Jakarta Metropolitan Area" with Carlos Mendez. *Asia-Pacific Journal of Regional Science*, 2026 (ESCI, Scopus Q1 — Urban Studies) <https://doi.org/10.1007/s41685-025-00415-4>
4. "Fake Customer Value: When Inflated Propositions Collapse in the Service Ecosystem" with Mohammed Y. I. Helal and Yogesh Dwivedi. *Journal of Consumer Behaviour*, 2026 (SSCI, Scopus Q1) <https://doi.org/10.1002/cb.70140>
5. "Regional Unemployment Dynamics in Indonesia: Serial Persistence, Spatial Dependence, and Common Factors" with Carlos Mendez. *Letters in Spatial and Resource Sciences*, 16:40, 2023 (ESCI, Scopus Q2 — Economics and Econometrics; Demography) <https://doi.org/10.1007/s12076-023-00364-6>

6. "Exploring Japan's Older Adults Mobility Challenges and the Potential Role of Autonomous Vehicles" with Andante Pandyaswargo and Hiroshi Onoda. *Transportation Research Part A: Policy and Practice*, Vol. 176, 2023 (SSCI, Scopus Q1) <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tra.2023.103818>
7. "Investigating the Effects of Minimum Wages on Employment, Unemployment and Labour Participation in Java Indonesia: A Dynamic Spatial Panel Approach" (solo). *Bulletin of Indonesian Economic Studies*, 58(2), pp. 195–227, 2022 (SSCI, Scopus Q1 — Economics & Econometrics) <https://doi.org/10.1080/00074918.2021.1914817>
8. "Impacts of Minimum Wages on Employment and Unemployment in Indonesia" (solo). *Journal of the Asia Pacific Economy*, 25(1), pp. 62–78, 2020 (SSCI, Scopus Q1 — Political Science & International Relations) <https://doi.org/10.1080/13547860.2019.1625585>

Under Review / Under Revision

1. "Digital Payments and Economic Growth in Saudi Arabia: Short- and Long-Run Evidence" with Adnan Bakather. **Major revision**, *International Journal of Islamic and Middle Eastern Finance and Management* (ESCI, Scopus Q1)
2. "Predicting Daily Emergency Department Arrivals Using Time-Series Modeling: Evidence from Saudi Arabia" with Rasha Alahmad et al. **Major revision**, *International Journal of Health Planning and Management* (SSCI, Scopus Q2)
3. "Do Fintech Spillovers Travel Across Borders? Evidence from a Global Spatial Panel" with Emilios Galariotis and Basel Awartani. **Under review**, *Economic Systems* (SSCI, Q1)

Funded Project in Progress

1. "Foreign Ownership Liberalization and Stock Market Quality: Evidence from Saudi Arabia" with Muhammad Imran Chaudhry and Muhammad Tahir Suleman. KFUPM Fintech Center Research Grant 2026.

Book Chapters, Conference Proceedings, & Policy Briefs (selected)

1. "Unlocking the Potential: The Economic Impact of Lao–China Railway" with Vicka Kharisma et al. Forthcoming, Springer Nature.
2. "Assessing Commuters' Satisfaction with Public Transportation in Jakarta Smart City" with Andante Hadi Pandyaswargo, Vicka Kharisma, Meilinda Maghfiroh, and Hiroshi Onoda. *Transportation Research Proceedia*, 2025. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.trpro.2025.03.067>
3. "Bridging the Infrastructure Investment Gap: Proposal for a Spillover Tax Sharing System" with Naoyuki Yoshino et al. *G20/T20 India 2023 Policy Brief*. https://t20ind.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/07/T20_PB_TF6_699_SpilloverTaxSharingSystem.pdf
4. "A Review of Literature on Post-Disaster Reconstruction for Communities and Individuals", with Dwicky Wibowo and Piyush Tiwari in *NAVIGATING RESILIENT POST-DISASTER RECOVERY IN ASIA AND THE PACIFIC*, pp: 11-22. Tokyo: Asian Development Bank Institute, 2023
5. "Spillover Effects of ICT Infrastructure: Empirical Evidence from India", with Naoyuki Yoshino, Deepanshu Agarwal, KE Seetha Ram, and Dina Azhgaliyeva in *Infrastructure Spillover Impacts in Developing Asia*, pp: 1 – 34. Tokyo: Asian Development Bank Institute, 2023. <https://doi.org/10.56506/HLDT1649>
6. "The Spillover Effects of Water Supply Infrastructure Development: A Theoretical Model" with Naoyuki Yoshino, Santi Setiawati, KE Seetha Ram, and Dina Azhgaliyeva in *Infrastructure Spillover Impacts in Developing Asia*, pp: 127 – 150. Tokyo: Asian Development Bank Institute, 2023. <https://doi.org/10.56506/HLDT1649>

Work in Progress

1. “From Landlocked to Land-Linked: Node-Based Local Economic Impacts of the Laos–China Railway from Nighttime Lights and Synthetic Difference-in-Differences” with Vicka Kharisma, Nilaphy Phommachanh, KE Seetha Ram, and Naoyuki Yoshino **(working paper available upon request)**
2. “The Effects of the Haramain High Speed Railway on Local Economic Activities in KSA” with Muhammad Imran Chaudhry and Andante Hadi Pandyaswargo **(working paper available upon request)**
3. “AI in Emergency Departments” with Rasha Alahmad and Nikhat Afshan
4. “Toward a Comparative Theory of Citation Advantage: Highly Cited Papers in Business and Economics in the Age of Artificial Intelligence” with Mohammed Y. I. Helal and Yogesh Dwivedi
5. “Financial Development and Economic Growth in Saudi Arabia” with Abdullah Abdulrahim Almeer

SELECTED AWARDS & GRANTS

- KFUPM Fintech Center Research Grant, 2026
- KFUPM Fintech Center Director's Special Recognition — Research Excellence Award, 2025
- Individual Research Grant, Waseda University, Japan, 2022–2023
- Young Doctoral Students Scholarship, Graduate School of Economics, Waseda University, 2017–2020
- Okazaki Kaheita International Scholarship, Japan, 2011–2014

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

- Universitas Surabaya Global Webinar — 'Indonesia Labor Market Updates' (2023)
- 59th Annual Conference, Japan Section of RSAI — Regional Unemployment Dynamics (2022)
- Asian Economic Development Conference, ADB — ICT Infrastructure Spillovers (2022)
- Nagoya University QuaRCS Network — Minimum Wages, Java Indonesia (2022)
- Australian National University, Indonesian Project, Forum Kajian Pembangunan — Minimum Wages, Java Indonesia (2021)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Referee: World Bank Economic Review, Spatial Economic Analysis, Journal of Economic Issues, Exchanges: The Interdisciplinary Research Journal, Discover Cities (Springer Nature), Journal of International Society for Southeastern Asian Agricultural Sciences

REFERENCES

Available upon request.